

JSS 3 NIGERIAN HISTORY – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 5: ELECTIONS AND ELECTORAL BODIES

1. INEC

The Independent National Electoral Commission (INEC) is the body responsible for organising federal and state elections in Nigeria. It registers voters, conducts elections, announces results and regulates political parties within the law. Independence and credibility of INEC are vital for public trust.

2. Electoral Reforms

Reforms have included improved voter registration, use of technology (e.g. card readers, result transmission innovations), legal changes to the Electoral Act, and efforts to reduce violence and fraud. Challenges remain: logistics, insecurity, vote-buying and disputes. Continuous reform aims at freer, fairer elections.

3. Role of Citizens

Register and vote; reject violence and bribery; report irregularities through legal channels; respect the outcome of credible elections or seek redress in court.

4. Summary

INEC runs Nigeria's elections; electoral reforms seek to improve credibility. Citizen participation and integrity are essential for democracy.

End of Topic 5